Box with lid and finial top

Philip Greenwood turns a decorative lidded box with a finial top

This month's article includes a simple box that could be a project in itself, however I've decided to make a finial to fit on the lid. This makes the box more of a show piece due to the length of the finial, which could be broken if used every day. This is something you have to take into account when you design or make an item. I discuss a client's requirements and then make sure that the finished design is fit for the purpose that it will be used for. This can be difficult but I would not want to supply an item that is not suitable for purpose.

This box is made from three pieces of timber – matching timber for the box, and a contrasting timber for the finial. I prefer a light timber for the box with a dark timber for the finial. The timber for the finial needs to be close and straight grain for maximum strength; grain running at an angle would be more vulnerable to break if rough handled, even if it made it through the turning process. The turning of the box is straightforward so long as you plan ahead, think carefully about how you are going to hold the parts and how you will finish off any chucking points used to finish the item off. Go through each process in your mind or on paper and make sure you will not run into problems. If you do foresee problems, change the process to an alternative method – better to do this than to waste a nice piece of timber due to not thinking the process through prior to turning the item. The box is finished with carnauba wax, which gives a more durable finish then beeswax.

PHOTOGRAPHS BY WENDY GREENWOOD

PHILIP GREENWOOD

Philip has been turning wood since 1980 and started turning professionally in 1986. He was accepted onto the Register of Professional Turners (RPT) in 2006. He is also a member of the AWGB. He can be seen working in his workshop in North Yorkshire and has demonstrated at the woodworking show at Harrogate since 2008. He runs courses at his workshop.

philip@woodturningintoart.co.uk
www.woodturningintoart.co.uk

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